

Patterns in problems

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Chess problem in the early years of its evolution were mere puzzles with difficult and surprising keys. At the turn of last century these developed into single phase problems with good thematic content. The later part of the last century witnessed rapid development of multi-phase ideas with set play changed mates, tries and patterns. The search had always been on for greater economy of construction, profundity of ideas and clarity of expression. Reciprocal change, a basic pattern theme (presented in the last article) featured changed mates after two black defences. Cyclic shift presented in this article is yet another popular pattern theme involving three black defences.

A.Pituk, First prize

Bansika Bystrica Theme Ty 1958



Mate in two moves

In cyclic shift, in one phase, either in the set or try, three defences a, b, c are met by mates A, B, C and in the post key, you will be baffled to observe, that the mates for the same three defences appear in a different order B, C, A. The above problem, a constructional masterpiece, is the only cyclic shift, in mutate form in existence.

Set play: 1...B any(a) 2.Bf6(A); 1...Kc5(b) 2. Bxe3(B); 1...e5(c) 2.d4 (C)

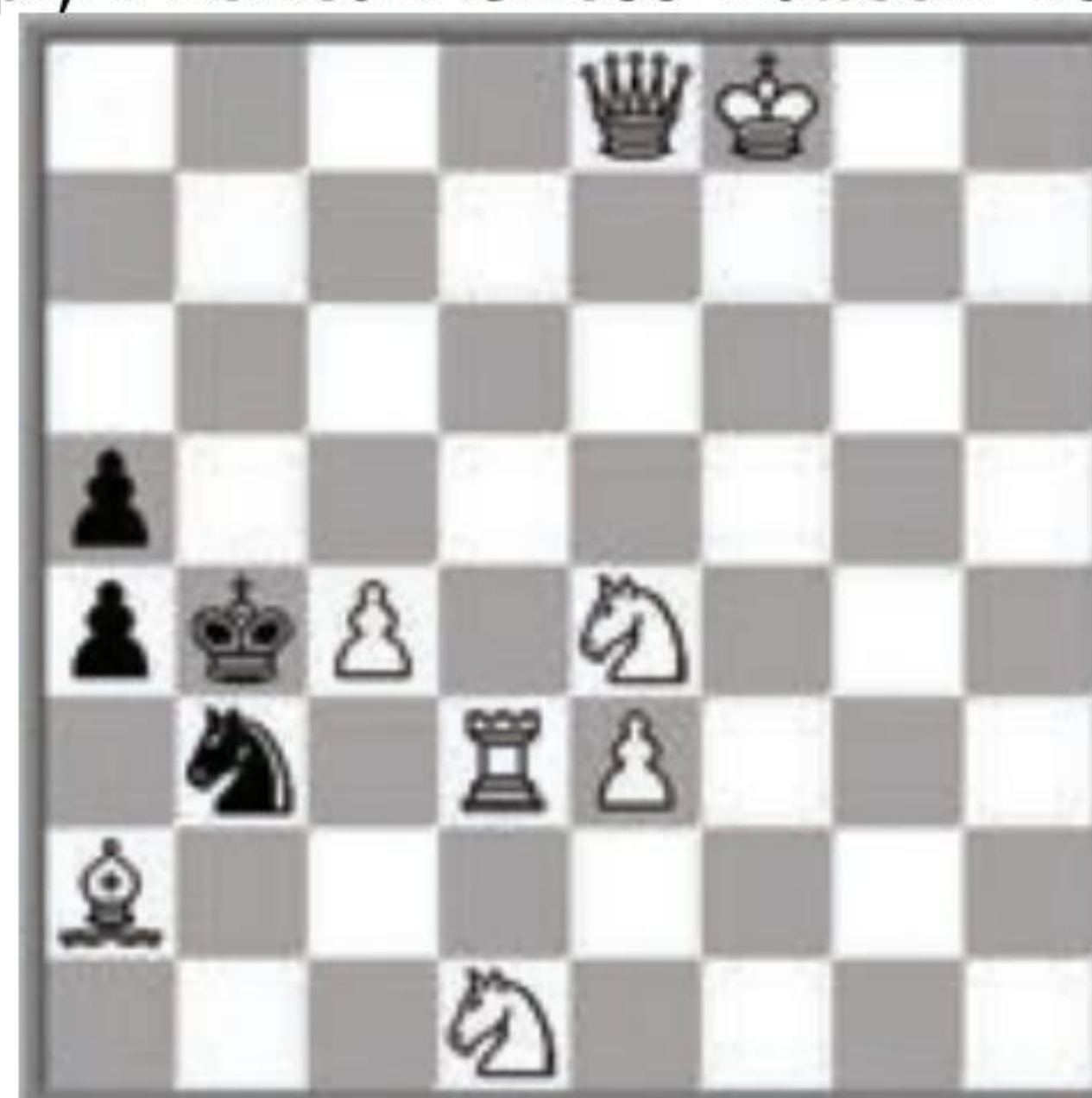
Key 1.Nd5! waiting

1...B any(a) 2.Bxe3(B); 1..Kc5 (b) 2.d4(C); 1...Ke5(c) 2.Bf6 (A)

Instead of mutate which poses lot of constraints in construction the same theme can be shown in try and key economically as below

R.E.Burger

I pr, American Chess Bulletin 1958



Mate in two moves

Try 1.Bb1? waiting

1...Kxc4 (a) 3.Qxa4 (A)

1...N random(b) 2.Qb5(B)

1...Ka3 (c) 2.Qe7(C)

Key 1.N(4)c3! Waiting

1...Kxc4 (a) 2.Qb5(B)

1...N random(b) 2.Qae7(C)

1...Ka3(c) 2.QAxa4 (A)

A cyclic shift for solving

C.G.S.Narayanan

The Problemist 1976



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article' Reciprocal change of mates'

Set: 1...Ka6 2.Bxc4 (A) 1...axb4

2.Bxb7 (B) **Key 1.Qe4!** (2.Qxc4)

1...Ka6 2.Bxb7 (B) 1...axb4 2.Bxc4

Readers may send in their queries to
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